

Philipp Hilbert. *AI Product Owner bridging deep technical fluency with structured delivery.*

Positioning, AI-native Product Owner with ten years of cross-functional delivery experience, ready to drive ML and GenAI projects end-to-end at ZEISS.

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§ WHY ZEISS

ZEISS sits at an unusual intersection: precision science with a century-long reputation, now investing seriously in AI through a dedicated Digital Technology Accelerator – not as a marketing exercise, but as a structural capability. The posting calls for someone who can hold both the technical architecture conversation and the stakeholder communication layer simultaneously, which is the exact gap most product teams struggle to fill. The requirement to understand "innovative flexibility at the shell and the power of standardisation at the core" resonates directly with how I have approached platform product work at Rohde & Schwarz and the Federal Employment Agency. *That dual-fluency, technical depth without losing the business thread, is where I do my best work.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My ML and data pipeline work has been on the data-preparation and platform side – feature engineering, ETL, audit trails, model evaluation tooling – rather than on model training itself. I have not owned a model-training roadmap end-to-end. The transferable mechanic I bring is strong: structuring the surrounding product (data provenance, tooling, deployment, stakeholder communication) so that data scientists and ML engineers can ship faster and with less coordination overhead.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafting and research synthesis
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo support and acceptance criteria validation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, specification and lightweight implementation work
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for concept validation
- **Framer**, design-heavy mock-up and stakeholder presentation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and documentation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, Git, Bitbucket, GitOps rollout pipelines.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ZEISS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow each active AI project team, map the current backlog state, stakeholder landscape, and where scope ambiguity is creating delivery drag across the ML, GenAI, and agentic workstreams.

WEEK 2

Slice and clarify.

Work with the technical experts to decompose the highest-priority backlog items into dev-ready user stories with clear acceptance criteria, surfacing misaligned assumptions before they reach sprint planning.

WEEK 3 +

Ship and close loops.

Run the first structured sprint reviews with department stakeholders, establish a lightweight lessons-learned cadence, and begin feeding those findings back into roadmap planning for subsequent AI projects.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Product Owner – Artificial Intelligence role at ZEISS. The position sits at the intersection I have spent the last several years building toward: technically demanding AI and data projects, cross-functional stakeholder environments, and the delivery discipline needed to move from scope definition to production rollout without losing either the engineering team or the business stakeholders along the way.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned the full product lifecycle of a central AI and data management platform built for the European defence programme FCAS. The platform handled multimodal datasets across image, audio, and tabular sources, with requirements for transparent model evaluation (SafeAI, ExplainableAI concepts), full data provenance, and reproducible transformation pipelines. I served as the interface between multinational stakeholders – architects, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA, and government programme leads – and delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end, from user stories and acceptance criteria through implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout. One infrastructure feature the project lead had been requesting from the engineering team for over a year I delivered independently in a single week. That is the kind of unblocking I consider part of the role, not exceptional effort.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I was responsible for a public analytics platform (Arbeitsmarktmonitor) covering regional labour market and demographic data. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, designed data governance structures, and served concurrently as Deputy IT Security Officer – giving me hands-on experience with confidential data handling and compliance requirements in a regulated environment. Both assignments involved exactly what ZEISS describes: operating as the interface between technical experts and non-technical departments, managing scope, and ensuring delivery momentum without sacrificing quality.

Earlier, at Emil Group, I took over a struggling B2B InsurTech platform mid-delivery. I restructured a bloated 17-person Scrum team into smaller, accountable units, reintroduced velocity tracking and refinement discipline, and rebuilt client trust through structured weekly product workshops. Reducing senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure in

a high-pressure environment required the same stakeholder management and organisational clarity your posting emphasises. These are not skills I have adjacent to the PM role – they are the core of how I work.

I bring fluent German and English, direct experience with cloud-deployed AI solutions, and an AI-native working style that means I ship artefacts – requirements documents, prototypes, structured analyses – faster and with fewer coordination cycles than a traditional PM workflow allows. ZEISS's Digital Technology Accelerator mandate – accelerating AI adoption across a precision science company – is exactly the kind of mission where that combination matters.

I would welcome a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience delivering AI systems, data platforms, and SaaS products in regulated and technically demanding environments. Proven track record managing the full project lifecycle – scope definition, agile execution, stakeholder alignment, and lessons-learned integration – for ML, data transformation, and analytics platforms. Comfortable serving as the interface between engineering teams and business departments, translating technical architecture into delivery roadmaps and business outcomes. Fluent in German and English; experienced with confidential data governance and compliance requirements.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end AI project delivery, from scope to production rollout
- Cross-functional stakeholder alignment across engineering, data science, and business
- Backlog management, sprint discipline, and velocity recovery in distressed teams
- Data platform ownership: ETL pipelines, data provenance, audit trails
- Cloud-deployed AI product experience (Kubernetes, ArgoCD, OpenShift)
- Prompt engineering, RAG concepts, and agentic workflow design
- Regulated environment delivery with data governance and compliance awareness
- Rapid prototyping and LLM-assisted requirements engineering

- Founder-level pragmatism: low overhead, high agency, clear communication

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned product lifecycle of a central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets (image, audio, tabular) within the European defence programme FCAS
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts covering SafeAI and ExplainableAI requirements
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and full data provenance audit trails
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered a long-requested feature in one week
- Led a cross-functional team: architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA, and multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform for regional labour market and demographic data
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; managed data lineage and governance standards
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, confidential data handling, and governance
- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Designed interactive dashboards, community features, and structured data presentation tooling

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned product delivery on a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline: split a bloated 17-person team into smaller Scrum units with ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices; rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops
- Managed budget and stakeholder expectations in a prototype-stage environment under delivery pressure
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows; managed complex legacy API dependencies
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical constraints

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- USP: setup under two minutes, no technical knowledge required; served as deputy IT security officer
- Presented the product to enterprise and government audiences in English and German

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype

- Platform later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

BUNDESDRUCKEREI (COVID-19 DATA PLATFORM) 2021, 2021

Product Owner

- Delivered secure data structures and identity management for RKI projects DIM and DESH

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware with complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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